a little over three months then, we decided that Veena should go ahead. Situations will never be ideal and we would work things out; if things didn't work, she could always quit. We hired a maid-cum-babysitter, and so began Veena's career as a teacher. She even acquired a BEd degree, and over the years, worked in prestigious schools all over India. St Mary's, Pune; Sophia's, Meerut; Bloom, New Delhi; as well as international schools in Yangon, Myanmar and Colombo, Sri Lanka. The fact that I was the training officer helped because, in the ten-minute break between classes or the tea break, I would swing by, change Isha's diaper and prepare her bottle of milk or cereal. That way, Isha was never alone with the maid for more than two hours or so. We would often ask our parents to come stay with us, which they did unhesitatingly. In fact, setting their own comforts aside, they would come singly, so that at least one parent was with us most of the time. My father would take Isha out for daily walks in her pram while we were both at work, and they became a familiar sight in the Cantonment.

After I had been at the Centre for a year or so, the Centre Adjutant, Capt H Bahadur, proceeded on permanent posting and I was appointed Adjutant in his place. This move brought me to the Centre HQ and directly under the Commandant. It also got me closer to the Records Office, where all the documentation of the men is done. A separate folder was maintained for each soldier from the time of his enrolment to retirement, tracking his every move and promotion, marriage, children, right up to his date of retirement and beyond. Even after his death, since his wife would be entitled to a pension, the records had to continue to be maintained, so it was not uncommon for the records to span a hundred years. It was a tedious task done manually based on inputs given by the units in the form of Part II Orders. It was based on this that the pay

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